



APSEZ's Dhamra Port stands as a symbol of the Adani Group's commitment to Odisha's growth.

rather than a gatekeeper. In practical terms, this translates into faster clearances, policy stability and execution certainty, factors that increasingly shape capital allocation decisions. Reflecting the Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani's philosophy of "seva hi sadhana hai" (service is worship), the infrastructure major has also deepened its association with Odisha through community service initiatives, including *seva* at the Lord Jagannath Puri Rath Yatra in 2025 in collaboration with ISKCON (International Society for Krishna Consciousness).

From Presence to Platform

The Adani Group already has an established presence in Odisha through ports and mining. What the current investment cycle signals is a shift from participation to platform-building. By investing simultaneously in digital infrastructure, power generation and construction materials, the Group is embedding itself across multiple layers of the state's economic architecture.

This creates not just operational presence, but strategic depth. The move also aligns with a broader national trend. As India seeks to diversify industrial growth beyond traditional hubs in the west and south, eastern states are gaining traction. Competitive land costs, resource availability and policy alignment are making them viable alternatives for capital-intensive projects. Adani's characterisation of the investment as a "statement of belief" underscores this transition. The bet is not just on individual projects, but on Odisha's ability to sustain and scale industrial growth over the long term. As the event concluded, Adani returned to a simple proposition: "What we build here today, we build for you and with you." For Odisha, the significance lies not just in the size of the investment, but in what it signals. If execution keeps pace with intent, the state could move from being resource-rich to infrastructure-led. This would mark an important and defining shift in India's evolving growth story.

that will support enterprise systems, digital governance and emerging technology ecosystems. This mirrors the role that ports and logistics networks have historically played in enabling trade and economic flows.

The ₹30,181-crore thermal power project addresses a more immediate constraint. Reliable power remains a prerequisite for sustained industrialisation, particularly in manufacturing-led growth models. The proposed plant is expected to stabilise the regional grid and support both industry and households that depend on uninterrupted supply.

The third leg, a ₹2,100-crore cement unit, completes the cycle. Infrastructure expansion inevitably drives demand for construction materials and localised production can reduce logistics costs while improving project timelines. In effect, the investment links demand creation with supply capability within the same geography.

Why Odisha, Why Now

Adani's articulation of Odisha's strengths reflects a broader shift in how investors are evaluating India's regional economies. The state combines a 570-km coastline with substantial mineral reserves, including coal, iron ore, bauxite and chromite, alongside a young workforce and steadily improving connectivity. Equally significant is the policy framework. Odisha's Vision 2036 and 2047 roadmap, which targets a \$500-billion economy by 2036 and \$1.5 trillion by 2047, provides a long-term directional signal that large investors typically seek. Adani also pointed to a shift in governance posture, describing the state as a partner



Gautam Adani, Chairman of the Adani Group, and his elder son Karan Adani during the Lord Jagannath Rath Yatra in Puri last year, reflecting the Group's philosophy of *seva*.